ANIMEBULK

TRAIN · EAT · GROW

THE 14-DAY KICKSTART

THE SHONEN BULK STARTER

Your numbers, a 3-day-a-week plan, a 3,000-calorie day and a tracking rule. Everything a skinny guy needs to start gaining in the next two weeks.

FREE EDITION

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READ THIS FIRST

Why Skinny Guys Stay Skinny (and the 14-Day Fix)

If you've trained before and nothing happened, it almost certainly wasn't the workout. It was the food. "Hardgainers" are nearly always under-eaters who believe they eat a lot. The second reason is training that never gets harder. This starter fixes both in the simplest possible way, so you can prove to yourself in 14 days that your body does respond.

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Know your numbers
Calories and protein for your bodyweight. Page 2.

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A 3,000-calorie day you can afford. Page 4.

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Track and adjust
Weigh in, average, adjust every 2 weeks. Page 5.

The four rules for the next 14 days

- **Hit your calories every day, including rest days.** Muscle is built on the days you don't train. Rest-day calories are not optional.
- **Train three times, never four.** More sessions with less recovery is how beginners stall. Mon/Wed/Fri or any three non-consecutive days.
- **Sleep 7–9 hours.** Growth hormone, recovery and appetite all live here. If you can only fix one habit, fix this one.
- **Write everything down.** Weights, reps, bodyweight. The log on page 5 is the whole system. No log, no progress.

What you need

A pair of adjustable dumbbells (any set that reaches 25–50 lb / 12–22 kg per hand), a doorway pull-up bar, and something to hold your food. That's it. No gym, no supplements required. A bodyweight-only version of every exercise is listed on page 3.

> **Who this is for.** Healthy adults who are skinny or skinny-fat, new to lifting or returning after a long break, and tired of guessing. If you're under 18, pregnant, injured, or have a medical condition, show this to a doctor before starting.

This guide is general fitness information, not medical or nutrition advice. Results vary with genetics, sleep, stress and consistency. Stop any exercise that causes sharp pain, dizziness or chest tightness. Anime titles and characters mentioned belong to their respective owners; ANIMEBULK is an independent fan site.

STEP 1

Your Numbers: Calories and Protein

For a skinny guy who trains three days a week, a reliable starting point is **bodyweight (lb) × 19 calories** per day and **0.8–1 g of protein per lb** (1.8–2.2 g per kg). The table below is that rule worked out. Start at the number for your weight, then adjust with the rule on page 5. For a personalized estimate that accounts for height, age and activity, use the free calculator at animebulk.com/calculator.

Bodyweight	Bulking calories / day	Protein target / day	Target weight gain
110 lb (50 kg)	2,100	90–110 g	+0.5–1 lb (0.25–0.5 kg) per week
120 lb (54 kg)	2,300	100–120 g	+0.5–1 lb per week
130 lb (59 kg)	2,500	105–130 g	+0.5–1 lb per week
140 lb (64 kg)	2,650	110–140 g	+0.5–1 lb per week
150 lb (68 kg)	2,850	120–150 g	+0.5–1 lb per week
160 lb (73 kg)	3,050	130–160 g	+0.5–1 lb per week
170 lb (77 kg)	3,250	135–170 g	+0.5–1 lb per week
180 lb (82 kg)	3,400	145–180 g	+0.5–1 lb per week

Why these numbers

Your maintenance calories (what keeps your weight stable) are roughly bodyweight × 15–17 for a lightly active young man. Adding 10–20% on top gives a surplus of 300–500 calories, which is enough to build muscle without piling on fat. Faster gains than 1 lb a week are mostly fat and water.

Protein at 0.8–1 g per lb is the range sports-nutrition research consistently supports for muscle growth. More than that doesn't help; less than 0.7 g per lb slows you down.

Three mistakes to avoid

- **Eating big on training days only.** Average across the week is what matters. Rest days count.
- **"Clean" foods only.** Chicken and broccoli is why you're skinny. Rice, oil, milk and peanut butter are your friends.
- **Guessing portions.** For the next 14 days, measure rice, oats and peanut butter with cups and spoons. You'll be surprised how little you were eating.

> **The one-sentence version:** eat your number every day, get your protein, and if the scale doesn't move in two weeks, eat 200 more. That's the entire science of bulking for a beginner.

STEP 2

The 14-Day Training Plan

Two full-body sessions, A and B, three days a week on non-consecutive days. **Week 1: A, B, A. Week 2: B, A, B.** Each session takes about 45 minutes including the warm-up. Rest 90 seconds between sets of the first three exercises and 60 seconds for the rest.

> **Warm-up (5 minutes, every session):** 2 minutes of jumping jacks or brisk walking, 10 arm circles each way, 10 bodyweight squats, 10 push-ups from the knees, then one light set of your first exercise with half the weight.

Session A

Exercise	Sets × Reps	No dumbbells? Do this instead
Goblet Squat	3 × 8–12	Bodyweight squat, 3 × 15–20, 3-second lowering
Dumbbell Floor Press	3 × 8–12	Push-ups, 3 × 8–15 (hands on a table if needed)
Dumbbell Bent-Over Row	3 × 10–12	Inverted rows under a sturdy table, 3 × 8–12
Dumbbell Romanian Deadlift	3 × 10–12	Single-leg glute bridge, 3 × 12 each side
Plank	3 × 30 sec	Same

Session B

Exercise	Sets × Reps	No dumbbells? Do this instead
Dumbbell Reverse Lunge	3 × 8–10 each leg	Bodyweight reverse lunge, 3 × 12 each leg
Dumbbell Overhead Press (standing)	3 × 8–10	Pike push-ups, 3 × 6–10
Pull-ups (band-assisted) or Inverted Rows	3 × 5–10	Negative pull-ups, 3 × 3–5 (5 seconds down)
Hip Thrust (shoulders on a couch)	3 × 12–15	Glute bridge, 3 × 15–20
Hanging Knee Raise or Dead Bug	3 × 10–12	Dead bug, 3 × 10 each side

How to make it harder (this is the whole secret)

When you can do the top of the rep range on **every** set with good form, add 2–5 lb (1–2 kg) per dumbbell next time and start again at the bottom of the range. For bodyweight moves, add reps or slow the lowering phase to 3 seconds. If you did the same weight for the same reps two sessions in a row, you didn't progress. Fix it next session.

> Form beats weight. Chest to a fist's height from the floor on push-ups, knees tracking over toes on squats, flat back on rows and deadlifts. If a weight makes your form fall apart, it's too heavy for now.

STEP 3

A 3,000-Calorie Day That Costs Almost Nothing

Scale portions up or down to match your number from page 2. Calories and protein are approximate; brands vary. The rule is simple: every meal has a carb, a protein and a fat, and milk fills the gaps.

Meal	What	Calories	Protein
Breakfast	1 cup dry oats cooked in 1 cup whole milk, 2 tbsp peanut butter, 1 banana	~745	26 g
Lunch	2 cups cooked rice, 6 oz chicken thigh, 1 tbsp olive oil, a handful of vegetables	~900	50 g
Snack	1 cup Greek yogurt + 1 oz (a handful) of nuts	~320	26 g
Dinner	6 oz ground beef (85%), 2 medium potatoes, a handful of vegetables	~810	46 g
Before bed	2 cups whole milk	~300	16 g
Total		**~3,075**	**~164 g**

The cheap bulking shopping list

Food	Why
Rolled oats	300 kcal per dry cup, pennies per serving
White rice	Easy calories that don't fill you up
Whole milk	150 kcal and 8 g protein per cup, drinkable
Eggs	70 kcal and 6 g protein each
Peanut butter	190 kcal per 2 tbsp, the hardgainer's best friend
Chicken thighs	Cheaper and more calories than breast
Ground beef (85%)	Protein, fat and iron in one pan
Potatoes, bananas	Cheap carbs, easy to add to any meal
Olive oil	120 kcal per tablespoon, invisible calories
Greek yogurt, canned tuna	Protein snacks that need no cooking

The 1,000-calorie shake

When you can't face another plate, drink it. Blend:

- 2 cups whole milk
- 1 cup rolled oats
- 2 tbsp peanut butter
- 1 banana (frozen is better)
- 1 scoop whey protein (optional, adds 24 g protein)

≈ 1,015 calories, 58 g protein with the whey, ≈ 895 and 34 g without. Add a tablespoon of honey or cocoa if you want it to taste like dessert.

> **Can't finish your food?** Eat 5 smaller meals instead of 3, drink calories (milk, shakes), add oil to rice and vegetables, and keep snacks visible on the counter. Appetite grows with practice.

STEP 4

Track It, Then Adjust Every Two Weeks

The weigh-in rule

- Weigh yourself **3 mornings a week**, after the bathroom, before food. Same scale, same conditions.
- Write the numbers in the log. Average each week. **Compare weekly averages, never single days.** Daily weight swings 2–4 lb from water and food.
- After 14 days, compare week 2's average with week 1's.

Adjust like this

Week 2 average vs week 1	Do this
Gained less than 0.5 lb (0.25 kg)	Add 200 calories a day. Rice, milk or a bigger shake.
Gained 0.5–1 lb (0.25–0.5 kg)	Perfect. Change nothing. Keep adding weight to the bar.
Gained more than 1.5 lb (0.7 kg)	Cut 150 calories a day. Mostly fat is coming on.

Repeat the check every 2 weeks. Your calorie number will rise as you grow. That's normal and it's the sign that it's working.

14-day log

Day	Weight	Trained?	Hit calories?
1		A	
2		rest	
3		B	
4		rest	
5		A	
6		rest	
7		rest	
8		B	
9		rest	
10		A	
11		rest	
12		B	
13		rest	
14		rest	

Week 1 average: _____ Week 2 average: _____

Prefer a spreadsheet? The free Level Up Tracker (Google Sheets / Excel) does the averages and the adjustment for you and logs every lift with an estimated one-rep max. Download it from animebulk.com/shop.

AFTER DAY 14

Level Up: Pick Your Character

Two weeks is enough to prove the system works. It's not enough to finish the job. Once the starter feels easy, move to a full character program. Every one of them uses the same rules you just learned, with more volume, a real progression schedule and a nutrition section that matches the training.

If you want…	Start here	Where
Size and strength, 12 weeks, dumbbells	Goku Workout: 12-Week Saiyan Muscle Program	animebulk.com/workouts/goku
A dense, powerful build with a bench	Vegeta Workout: The Saiyan Prince Strength Program	animebulk.com/workouts/vegeta-workout
Lean and explosive, 6 weeks	Satoru Gojo Workout	animebulk.com/workouts/satoru-gojo-workout
No equipment at all	Luffy Workout: Bodyweight Strength and Grip	animebulk.com/workouts/luffy-one-piece-workout
Daily-quest discipline, Solo Leveling style	Sung Jin-Woo Workout	animebulk.com/workouts/sung-jinwoo-workout
The famous 100-100-100-10 km, done safely	Saitama Workout	animebulk.com/workouts/saitama-one-punch-man-workout

Keep eating like you mean it

The full **Skinny Guy's Guide to Gaining Muscle** at animebulk.com/nutrition covers meal plans by calorie level, the whey vs. mass gainer question, and five smoothies between 800 and 1,000 calories.

Set up a $100 home gym

Adjustable dumbbells, a pull-up bar and a mat cover every program on the site. Our researched picks, with what to skip, are at animebulk.com/gear.

Coming soon: The Shonen Bulk Protocol

The full 90-day version of this starter: three phases, week-by-week loading, a complete meal plan at four calorie levels and the plateau fixes. Subscribers hear first, at a subscriber price.

Found this useful?

Send it to the skinny friend who keeps saying he "can't gain weight". Then send us your 14-day result at **hello@animebulk.com**. We read every one.

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